Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

803
5 0.63%
Dec 10th, 2024

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

915
5.00 0.55%
Dec 10th, 2024

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

716
2 0.28%
Dec 10th, 2024

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

109.61
1.81 1.68%
Dec 10th, 2024

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

118.09
0.49 0.42%
Dec 10th, 2024

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

900
5 0.56%
Week Ending Dec 6th, 2024

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2501 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

817.00
8.50 1.05%
Dec 10th, 2024 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
January 25 USD/dmt

105.45
0.30 0.29%
Dec 10th, 2024 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2501 (Jan) RMB/t

3402
72 2.16%
Dec 10th, 2024 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

17.56
0.08 0.46%
Dec 9th, 2024

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

7.42
0.00 0.07%
Dec 9th, 2024

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3403
-4 -0.10%
Week Ending Dec 6th, 2024

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

145.84
-1.46 -0.99%
Week Ending Dec 6th, 2024

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

18.02
-0.04 -0.19%
Week Ending Dec 6th, 2024

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3500
-10 -0.27%
Week Ending Dec 6th, 2024

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Dec 10th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	803	5	0.6%	782	872	683	1063	103.69	0.63	0.6%	101.26	114.10	89.33	140.24
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	716	2	0.3%	693	765	610	963	93.06	0.24	0.3%	90.29	100.69	80.25	128.13
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	915	5	0.5%	894	984	794	1175	118.67	0.63	0.5%	116.29	129.17	104.47	155.37

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Dec 10th, 2024		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	109.61	1.81	1.68%	103.97	115.38	89.79	142.65
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	118.09	0.49	0.42%	117.16	132.89	98.28	171.65

MARKET COMMENTARY

Today, Dalian iron ore futures opened higher and continued to rise, reaching a peak of 833 yuan/mt before slightly retreating. The most-traded contract I2501 fluctuated upward throughout the day and finally closed at 817 yuan/mt, up 1.87% for the day. Traders were actively selling, while steel mills remained cautious with moderate purchase willingness. Market transactions were relatively few today. In Shandong, the mainstream transaction prices for PB fines were 795-800 yuan/mt, up 5 yuan/mt from yesterday; in Tangshan, the transaction prices for PB fines were 810-815 yuan/mt, up 5-10 yuan/mt from yesterday.

Yesterday's Politburo meeting released several positive signals, indicating that future monetary and fiscal policies will be relatively loose, which significantly boosted market sentiment. However, according to SMM's survey on blast furnace maintenance, due to environmental protection-driven production restrictions in Hebei, many steel mills were forced to shut down and maintain their blast furnaces. The impact from maintenance increased by more than 200,000 mt WoW. This weakened the demand for iron ore, limiting the rise in ore prices. Nevertheless, considering the upcoming economic conference, market sentiment remains optimistic, and ore prices are expected to maintain a fluctuating upward trend in the short term.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Dec 6th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-oW	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	900	5	0.6%	883	1012	820	1210	111.48	0.35	0.31%	110.27	127.29	102.77	153.57

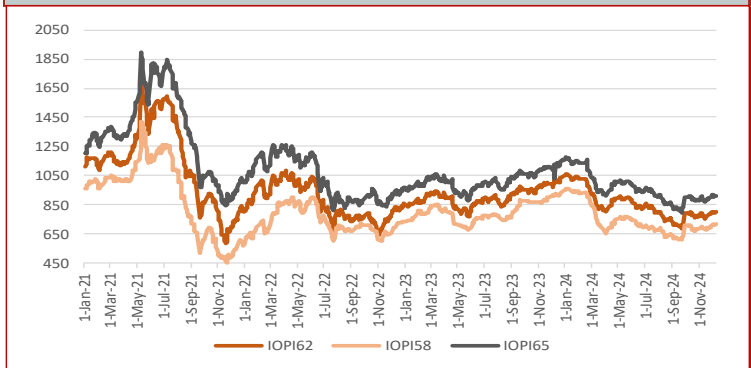
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Dec 6th, 2024				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	963	2.1%	861	1226	133.93	2.14%	122.41	172.59
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	990	0.0%	965	1300	137.68	0.02%	135.54	183.23
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	740	0.7%	715	970	102.91	0.70%	100.77	136.72
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	996	2.4%	905	1294	138.52	2.38%	128.66	182.16

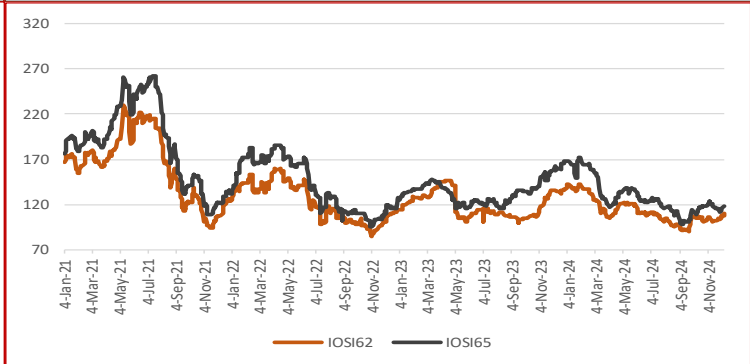
Week Ending Dec 6th, 2024	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	884.12	0.48%	854.16	905.40

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 7.191 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =7.19258

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Dec 10th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	765	718	781	779	782	763	872	99.33	93.70	102.03	100.71	101.26	99.03	114.10
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	656	630	690	692	693	670	765	85.58	82.73	90.61	89.97	90.29	87.48	100.69
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	876	829	894	891	894	874	984	114.39	108.89	117.10	115.71	116.29	114.12	129.17

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Dec 10th, 2024		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	99.33	94.36	104.02	103.09	103.97	100.65	115.38
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	114.06	102.24	115.31	117.71	117.16	112.65	132.89

FREIGHT RATES

Dec 9th, 2024		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	7.42	0.00	0.07%	7.38	14.89
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	17.56	0.08	0.46%	17.48	35.02

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Dec 6th, 2024		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	911	830	888	876	883	867	1012	114.10	104.46	111.82	109.09	110.27	108.48	127.29

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Dec 10th, 2024		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-87	-10.83%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	112	13.95%

Dec 10th, 2024		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	8.48	7.74%

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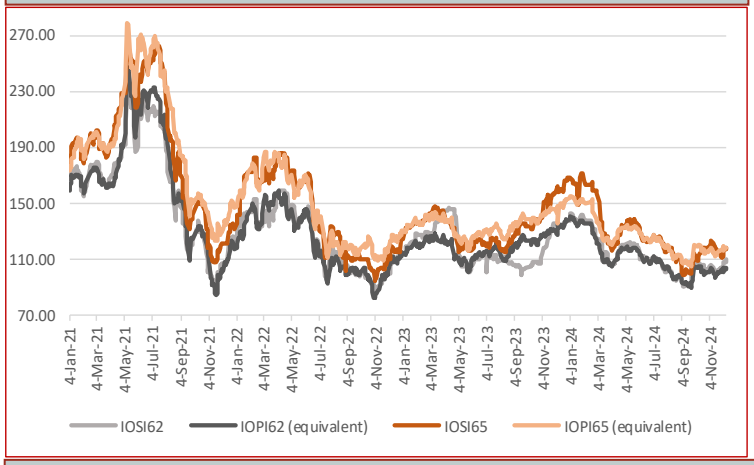
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Dec 10th, 2024	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	746	5	-57
SIMEC Fines	674	5	-129
PB Fines	772	5	-31
Newman Fines	771	5	-32
MAC Fines	753	5	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	667	5	-136
Carajas Fines	983	5	180
Brazilian SSF	766	6	-37
Brazilian Blend Fines	785	5	-18
RTX Fines	686	5	-117
West Pilbara Fines	715	5	-88

Dec 10th, 2024	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	105.11	1.81	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	101.61	1.81	-8.00
PB Fines	105.86	1.81	-3.75
Newman Fines	108.74	1.81	-0.88
MAC Fines	105.86	1.81	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	98.24	1.81	-11.38
Carajas Fines	139.16	1.81	29.55
Brazilian SSF	113.36	1.81	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	114.99	1.81	5.38
RTX Fines	99.49	1.81	-10.13
West Pilbara Fines	103.86	1.81	-5.75

Dec 10th, 2024	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	716	2	0
FMG Blended Fines	725	2	9
Robe River	726	3	10
Western Fines	728	2	12
Atlas Fines	722	2	6
Yandi	709	2	-7

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	5.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	15.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	20.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	35.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	9.00	4.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	20.00	4.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	14.00	-1.00
	Low Fe Grade	5.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	7.00	1.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	7.00	1.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	1.50	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	3.50	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	3.50	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	3.50	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	5.00	1.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	1.00	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	0.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	0.25	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	1.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	0.25	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-50.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-25.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-15.00	0.00	Jingtang	-10.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-20.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-30.00	0.00

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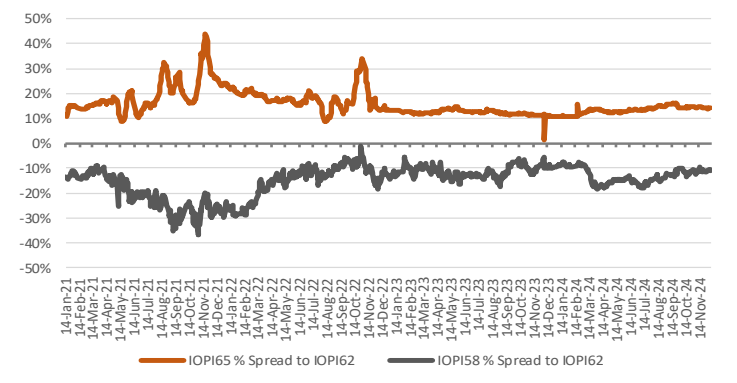
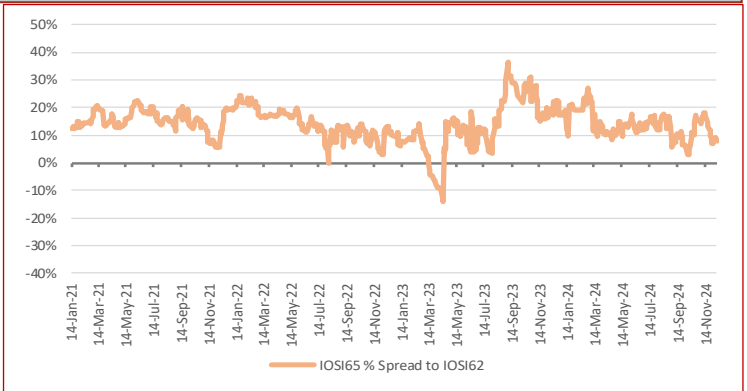
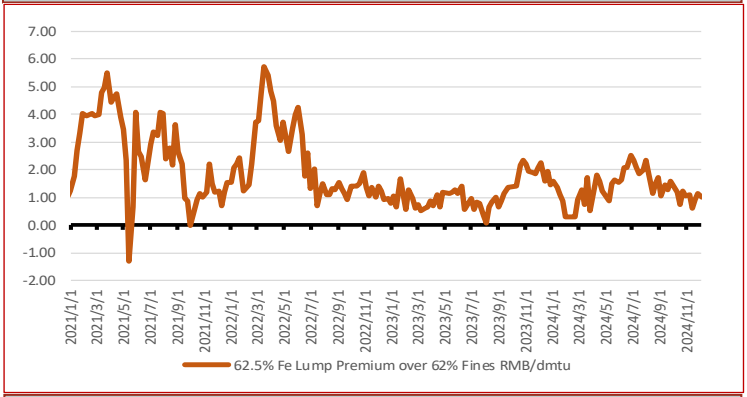
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

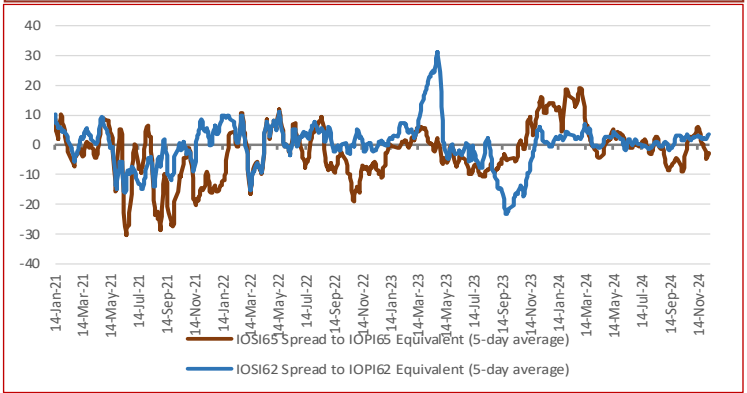




WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)

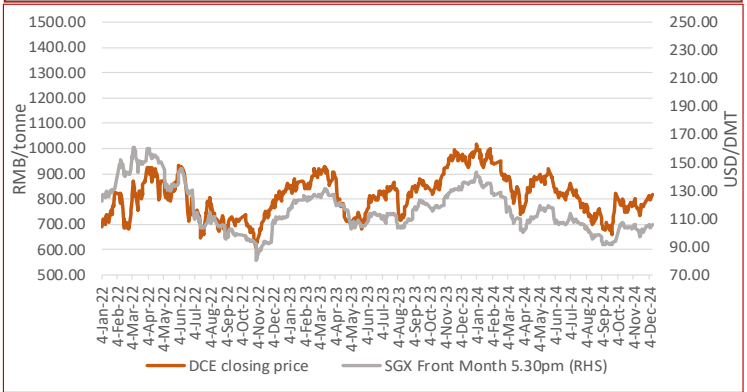


IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)

FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

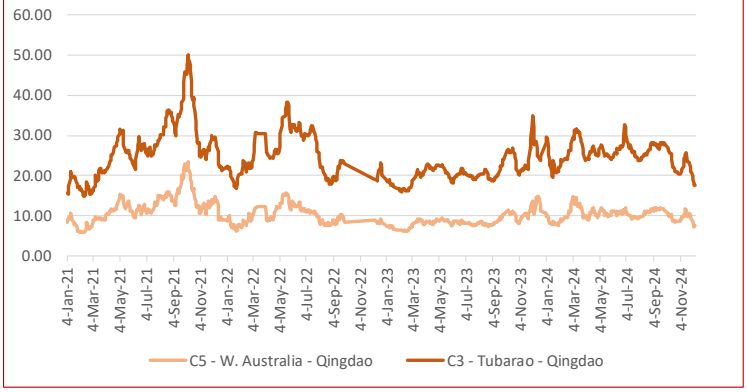
Week Ending Dec 6th, 2024

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	13.41	-2.47%	8.29	17.20
Qingdao	25.02	-1.88%	22.28	25.81
Caofeidian	18.64	-4.26%	7.56	20.28
Tianjin	11.37	-4.29%	6.64	12.16
Rizhao	19.62	-4.25%	11.52	21.35
Total (35 Ports)	145.84	-0.99%	105.01	150.72

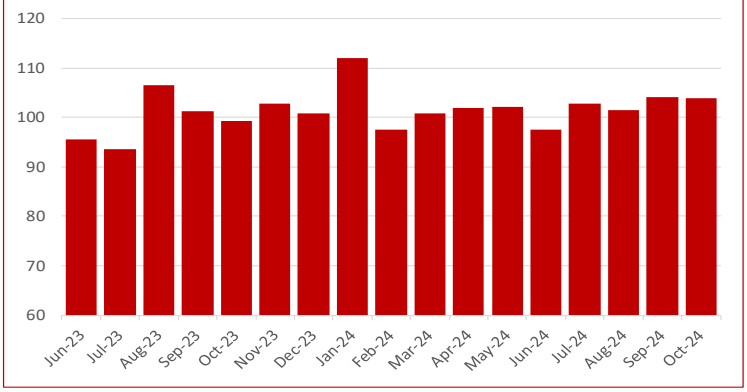
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Dec 10th, 3pm close			Dec 10th, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2501	Change	Change %	Jan. 25	Change	Change %
Closing Price	817.00	8.50	1.05%	105.45	0.30	0.29%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	27.86	4.39	18.70%	9.23	1.68	22.31%
Open positions ('000 lots)	20.63	-2.91	-12.38%	35.83	0.99	2.83%
Day Low	812.0	22.00	2.78%	104.95	2.40	2.34%
Day High	833.0	21.50	2.65%	107.30	2.00	1.90%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2024/12/06	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,403	-4	-0.10%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,576	-8	-0.22%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,500	-10	-0.27%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	4,153	20	0.48%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,630	10	0.28%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	4,440	0	0.00%
Colour Coated Plate	6,750	50	0.75%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

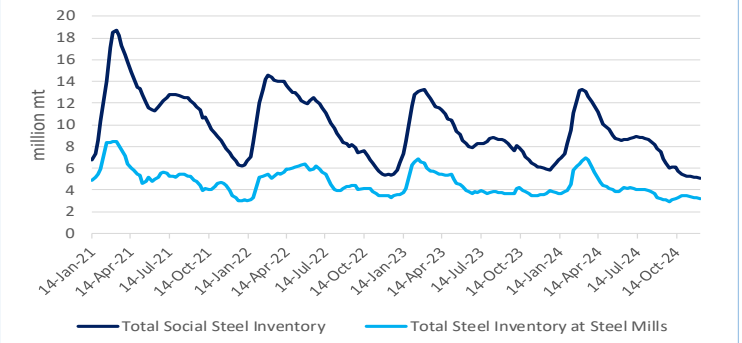
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	102.42	0.04	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	1,955	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,560	50	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	2,724	5	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,304	6	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	56	-26	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,375	7	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	85	-27	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

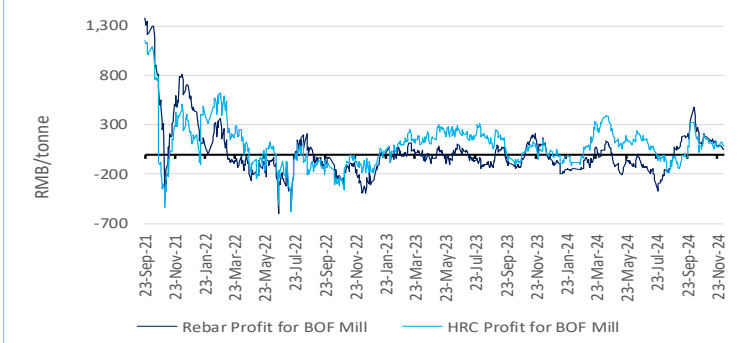
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

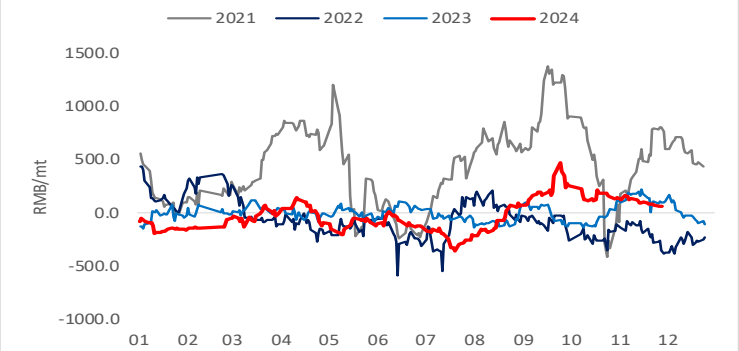
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

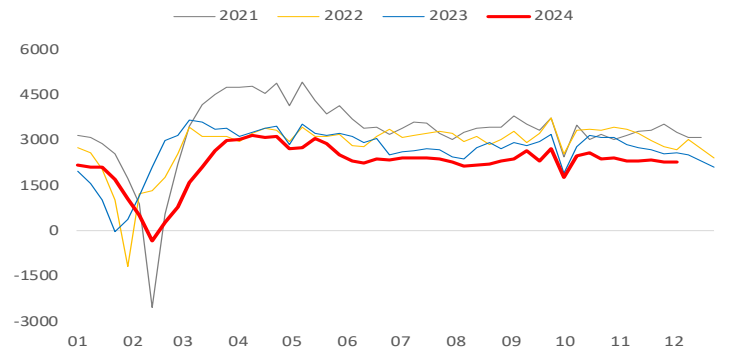


CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar

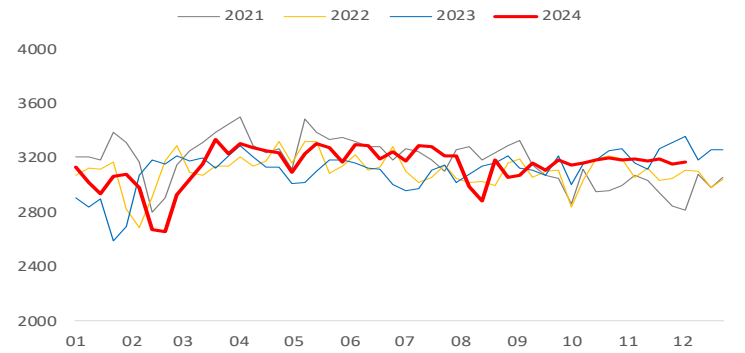


CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil

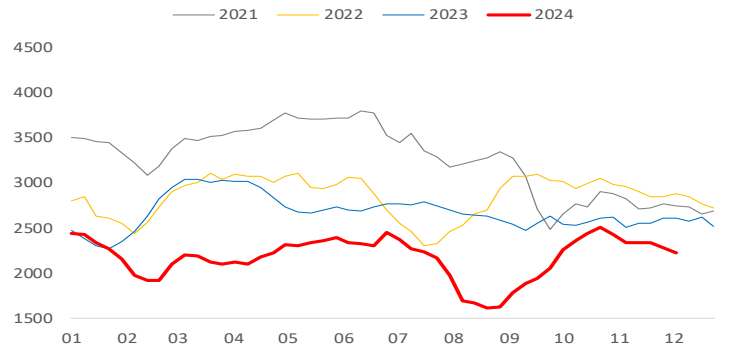
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



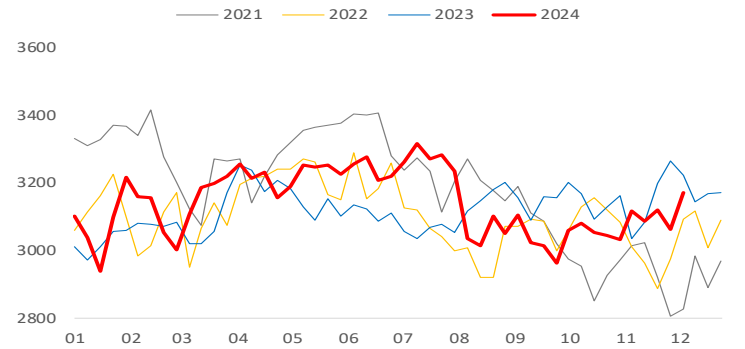
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Dec 10th, 2024	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Dec 10th, 2024	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.40%	0.090%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.70%	0.080%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.00%	4.50%	0.120%	8.00%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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